This Is Why We Have NDAS

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This Is Why We Have NDAS

by Lunaeryi

Summary

A globally adored idol and an aloof rockstar are hopelessly obsessed with each other—and it’s ruining everything. Their mortal enemy managers are just trying to survive. Featuring: fake scandals, real feelings, powerpoints, blackmail folders, and a PR team held together by wine and sheer spite.

Notes

Was genuinely tweaking out for a few days cause I lost my Social Security Card, but found it a few hours ago, so I decided what better way to celebrate not getting deported than finishing this ff’s writing in my drafts😍? (A bit late to the party I know)

Anyway point out any mistakes u see and hope u enjoy reading <3333333333333

See the end of the work for more notes

The room is pristine, lined with glass panels that reflect the morning sun in sharp, sterile streaks. A long conference table stretches through the center, occupied by a team of well-dressed professionals, their faces taut with stress. The air hums with tension, punctuated only by the quiet shuffle of papers and the occasional clearing of a throat.

Aglaea steps inside with the practiced grace of someone who has spent years perfecting the art of composure. Not a hair is out of place, her sleek attire immaculate despite the brutal schedule she keeps. In one hand, she holds a tablet; in the other, a steaming cup of black coffee—her lifeline. She has handled scandals, diffused PR nightmares, and sculpted careers with nothing but precision and eloquence. This, whatever it is, will be no different.

At least, that's what she thinks.

Without a word, the head of marketing gestures to the screen at the front of the room. A single image takes up the entire display. A shirt, garish in its bright colors, with text so unmistakable that Aglaea feels a migraine form instantly.

MYDEISIMP4EVER.

A URL sits underneath it. She follows the link with her eyes, expression betraying nothing. The site does not exist—yet.

There is a silence, thick and expectant, as if the entire team is collectively holding its breath.

Aglaea exhales slowly. "Tell me that's not official merch."

A familiar voice—warm, charismatic, utterly unbothered—breaks the silence.

"Not yet," Phainon says cheerfully, stepping into the room. "But give me a Canva and five minutes."

The marketing team looks like they might cry.

Aglaea pinches the bridge of her nose. It’s too early for this.

Aglaea prides herself on efficiency. She built her career on precision, navigating the chaotic world of idol management with an unshakable sense of control. Image is everything, and she has spent years ensuring that Phainon’s remains untouchable.

Phainon is, after all, one of the most successful idols of his generation. He has the voice, the stage presence, the effortless charm that makes cameras adore him. He knows exactly how to carry himself in interviews, how to hold a crowd in the palm of his hand, how to turn even the briefest interaction into something that lingers.

But for all his polish and natural charisma, Phainon has one glaring weakness.

And that weakness is currently standing in the doorway, effortlessly derailing the carefully maintained professionalism of this emergency meeting.

The problem isn’t that Phainon has a public relationship—idols dating is nothing new, and the industry has evolved enough that his fanbase, while intense, has largely embraced it. No, the problem is that Phainon is dating Mydei, a rockstar with a fanbase just as rabid as his own, and Phainon is not merely dating him.

He is *obsessed* with him.

Where other celebrities keep their relationships subtle, Phainon treats his like an all-consuming religion. He does not simply love Mydei; he worships him, sings his praises with a fervor that borders on unhinged. Every public appearance, every social media post, every breath he takes seems to be an extension of his devotion.

And now, apparently, he is looking to monetize it.

Aglaea does not sit. She remains standing, tapping her nails against the side of her coffee cup as she considers her words carefully. “Phainon,” she

begins, voice calm, measured, as if speaking to a wayward child, “do you understand why this might be an issue?”

Phainon tilts his head, perfectly at ease. “Because I haven’t set up the store yet?”

Someone in the marketing team makes a noise that sounds dangerously close to a sob.

Soon after, Castorice enters the room quietly, moving with the kind of effortless calm that makes her hard to notice until she’s already there. She doesn’t speak right away, just gives Aglaea a small nod before settling onto the couch in the corner. She pulls out her phone, scrolling absently.

Phainon, who had been standing idly by the conference table, instantly lights up at the sight of her. He does a complete 180, turning away from Aglaea’s impending lecture as if it no longer exists.

“Oh, good, you’re here,” he says, all smooth charisma replaced with raw enthusiasm. “I have to tell you something.”

Castorice barely looks up from her screen. “Hmm.”

“Mydei’s new song.” His voice is already *dangerously* emotional. “It’s so good.”

Castorice, still scrolling. “That’s nice.”

“No, you don’t understand,” Phainon insists, moving closer like this is the most urgent conversation of their lives. “He looked at me when he sang the second chorus.”

Castorice spares him a glance. “You were standing in the front row.”

“He sang it for me.”

Castorice stares at him, then past him, then directly into the void, where she hopes some higher power will grant her strength.

Aglaea, who has been listening with increasing apprehension, folds her arms. “Phainon,” she says with eerie calm, “what exactly do you mean by that?”

Phainon immediately launches into an enthusiastic retelling, completely unfazed by her tone. “Okay, so *technically* I had a schedule that day, but I really needed to be there, and Castorice had an idea—”

Castorice, who had been hoping to avoid eye contact with Aglaea altogether, suddenly pales. Without hesitation, she reaches over and slaps a hand over Phainon’s mouth.

Aglaea watches this unfold, her patience thinning at an alarming rate. “Let me make sure I understand this correctly.” She gestures lightly with one hand, voice smooth, carefully controlled. “You mean to tell me that you left practice—without informing me—to attend a concert?”

Phainon, still slightly muffled by Castorice’s hand, nods enthusiastically.

“And from what I’m gathering,” Aglaea continues, “Castorice helped you.”

Castorice looks increasingly like she regrets every choice that led her to this moment.

Aglaea closes her eyes for a brief second, pressing her fingers lightly to her temple. Something clicks into place—a memory, sharp and vivid.

Last week. Phainon had been trending.

The PR team had scrambled, confused, insisting it couldn’t have been him because he was supposed to be *across the city* at the time. She had signed off on a carefully worded statement confirming that fact.

And yet.

She remembers now. The grainy fan footage, the low-quality Twitter videos.

Phainon, in sunglasses and absolutely no other form of disguise, screaming the lyrics to Mydei's song louder than the actual fans.

A concerned security guard approaching him. "Sir, do you… need medical assistance?"

Phainon, eyes wild with adoration: "No. I need him."

Aglaea exhales sharply through her nose.

Another memory. A different scandal, equally stupid.

Phainon at Mydei's fan meet, despite being Mydei's actual boyfriend.

He had snuck into the line, absolutely refused to break character, and had somehow managed to make the entire event about *him*.

The moment he reached the front of the line, he had gasped, wide-eyed, as if he hadn't just woken up in Mydei's bed that morning.

"Oh my god, it's you!" Phainon had practically *vibrated* with excitement. "Can you sign my forehead?"

Mydei, entirely too amused, had actually done it.

Aglaea remembers.

Slowly, she opens her eyes, gaze sharp as it lands on the two idols in front of her. Phainon at least has the decency to look vaguely apologetic. Castorice, clearly resigned, avoids eye contact.

Phainon reaches out, giving her a gentle, apologetic pat on the shoulder.

Aglaea inhales deeply. This is going to be a very, very long day.

Phainon and Castorice are both, for lack of a better term, *grounded*.

Not in the literal sense—Aglaea can't exactly confiscate Phainon's mic like a parent taking away a game console—but in the cold, corporate way that makes life just a little more miserable.

For Phainon, it means an immediate increase in supervised PR activities. More interviews, more carefully curated public appearances, and a very stern reminder that disappearing to attend his boyfriend's concerts is, in fact, not part of his job description.

For Castorice, who had simply been caught in the crossfire, it means more public engagements. Nothing extreme—Aglaea wouldn't force her into anything she'd *genuinely* hate—but just enough to make her regret ever agreeing to Phainon's dumb plan. More interviews, more photoshoots, more moments where she has to actually interact with people instead of quietly lurking in the background.

It's a punishment in the pettiest way possible. And Aglaea is very, very good at being petty.

But there is one thing Aglaea *can't* control.

Phainon's Twitter account.

Despite her best efforts, despite explicit instructions to think before he posts, Phainon continues to be an unstoppable force of unhinged social media activity.

His tweets are a menace to society.

> Mydei just breathed and I'm shaking, throwing up, crying, and writing his last name after mine in my notes app.
>
> Might start barking if I see Mydei in that leather jacket again.
>
> Respectfully? Mydei could run me over and I'd say thank you.

Aglaea stares at her inbox. Every single morning, without fail, there are at least three emails from sponsors, all varying degrees of concerned.

She resists the urge to slam her forehead against her desk. Instead, she sends a text.

Aglaea: Phainon. I need you to stop tweeting.

Phainon: No ❤

Aglaea stares at her screen in exhausted silence.

She closes her laptop.

She needs a drink.

Aglaea moves with her usual grace, every motion smooth and deliberate as she pours herself a drink. To the untrained eye, she is the picture of composure—elegant, refined, unshaken by the absolute circus she manages daily.

And yet, if one were to look closely, they might notice the faint twitch of her eyebrow, the barely-there tension in her jaw.

She takes a slow sip, savoring the brief moment of peace.

Then, her phone vibrates.

She exhales through her nose and checks the notification.

And immediately regrets it.

Phainon's verified, official account has just posted the following:

> Just saw Mydei's new Instagram post. I need to go feral in a corner.

Aglaea doesn't move for a full five seconds.

Then, against her better judgment, she digs deeper.
Within minutes, she finds it. The real disaster.

Phainon has been caught red-handed running a Mydei fan account on TikTok.

And it is *insane*.

> @MydeisLightOfMyLife posts include:
> • Thirst edits of Mydei with obnoxiously dramatic transitions.
> • Stitching hate comments with “I hope your pillow is warm on both sides.”
> • A three-minute video of Phainon texting Mydei “I love you” in different fonts.

Aglaea pinches the bridge of her nose.

How did she not notice this sooner? The account had gained thousands of followers, with fans debating in the comments whether it was actually Phainon or just an extremely dedicated impersonator.

The debate ended the moment Phainon forgot to switch accounts and posted his unfiltered feral thoughts from his verified main.

Her phone vibrates again. A new text.

From Phainon.

Phainon: okay that was actually a mistake I didn’t mean to do that

Aglaea stares at her screen in silence. A second later, as if it’d magically fix something:

Phainon: I’m sorry.

She contemplates, very seriously, drinking on the job.

The studio is too loud. Not because of any noise—on the contrary, it’s dead silent—but because the silence hits like a wave the second Anaxa walks through the doors.

Stylists, interns, even producers sidestep him with all the urgency of prey sensing a predator. No one makes eye contact. No one dares speak.

He doesn't need to say a word.

Clipboard in hand, tablet under one arm, and a latte in the exact shade of beige he tolerates, Anaxa strides through the hall like he owns it. In a way, he does. The only person with more power in this place is the very rockstar he's here to manage.

He reaches the central whiteboard where Mydei's weekly agenda is pinned —carefully written in multicolor markers by someone with far too much hope left in their soul.

Anaxa clicks his pen once, crosses out Thursday's scheduled livestream, and replaces it with "*Nothing.*"

He underlines it. Twice.

No one asks why.

He continues down the hall, boots perfectly muffled against the studio floor, until he reaches his private office. The door closes behind him with a quiet finality.

Inside, with the filtered air and controlled lighting, he finally exhales. Sits. Places his latte beside him with surgical precision.

His tablet blinks on.

He opens a new email draft.

Subject: Regarding Your Rockstar's Boyfriend Being A Federal Threat (Again)

He stares at the screen for a long moment. Types one line.

"To whom it may concern, please get your golden menace in line—"

Pause. Delete.

He drags the document to the trash and instead opens a tab titled **“Skincare Routine - Emergency Tier.”**

There’s a line halfway down the *doc: “Do not let this industry age you. You are above stress.”*

Anaxa reads it three times before sighing and minimizing the window.

His phone buzzes.

He doesn’t check it. He already knows.

His phone lights up.

Aglaea is typing…

He doesn’t even glance at the preview. Just sighs like a man carrying the weight of a hundred PR disasters and one very dramatic celestial idol.

He locks the screen without reading it. One less migraine today.

Somewhere on his drive exists a cursed document labeled:
“Phainon Incident Tracker – Shared Access (Unfortunately).”

He’s updated it more times than he’s said “good morning” this year.

To calm himself, Anaxa opens a tab and scrolls through the new anti-aging serum releases. He’s on his third “best reviewed” video this week.

There’s a moment of quiet as he adds a vitamin C cream to his cart.

Another buzz.

He closes the tab. Reopens the skincare doc. Adds a line.

Wrinkles are a choice. So is working with Aglaea.”

He considers adding a footnote. Deletes it. The damage is already done.

The “meeting” takes place like most of their meetings do—quiet, clinical, with the atmosphere of a divorce proceeding that never legally ended.

Anaxa stands at the head of the table, sleek tablet in hand, clicking through slides with a smooth efficiency that should’ve impressed anyone not already desensitized to his perfectionism.

Mydei, across from him, sits with one leg slung over the other, black nail polish chipped on one hand, chewing thoughtfully on a straw from an iced drink he didn’t offer to share. Sunglasses still on indoors. A cardigan two sizes too big slipping off his shoulder like he styled it that way (he didn’t).

“Venue schedule’s been updated for the next leg,” Anaxa begins, tone smooth but sharp enough to slit a throat. “Tokyo’s set. Seoul’s negotiating for a solo encore. LA wants a VIP pop-up, but they’re pushing for custom merch.”

Mydei nods. Maybe. He might’ve blinked.

Anaxa doesn’t wait. “New collab inquiry came in from that indie brand you like—violet-themed makeup or something. I already declined the influencer-tier one.”

“Mm.”

That usually means thank you.

They move through the topics like clockwork. Until—

“Post on Instagram,” Anaxa says, flat.

“I posted yesterday.”

Anaxa stops. One brow lifts. Slowly, calmly, he turns his screen around. Pulls up the post. It’s a grainy, out-of-focus shot of Mydei’s guitar leaning against a wall. No filter. No caption besides: hm.

“You’re aware this isn’t Tumblr in 2012, right?”

Mydei lifts his eyes just enough to look at him over the rim of his sunglasses. “Are you sure?”

Anaxa stares at him.

Mydei takes another sip.

Silence.

“I’ll post another one,” he offers, at last. “Maybe a shoe this time.”

Anaxa breathes in through his nose. Refuses to dignify it with a response.

As the last slide clicks off and Anaxa closes his tablet with a crisp finality, there’s a lull—brief, heavy with the promise of freedom.

Then, casually, like commenting on the weather:

“Phainon’s fan account went viral. Again.”

Mydei doesn’t even look up at first. Just blinks once. “Which one?”

Anaxa’s eye twitches. “The one where he texted ‘I love you’ in every font available on mobile.”

“Ah.” Mydei hums, like he’s mildly impressed. “He did say he was downloading font packs last week.”

“That wasn’t a green flag,” Anaxa says, folding his arms. “That was a cry for help.”

Mydei finally glances up, neutral as ever. “And?”

“And,” Anaxa deadpans, “your boyfriend has the media literacy of a turnip.”

A beat passes. Mydei leans back, thoughtful. “Is it really that bad?”

Anaxa doesn’t even blink. “If he weren’t famous and hot, yes. I’d be filing restraining orders.”

There’s a pause, then the faintest smirk tugs at Mydei’s lips.

Anaxa pretends not to notice. Pretends harder not to care.

Anaxa exhales slowly, like this moment physically pains him.

“Just consider telling him to stop.”

Mydei raises a brow. “Stop what?”

“I don’t know.” Anaxa’s tone is calm. Controlled. But there’s a glint of desperation buried under the marble surface. “Breathing in your direction. Memorizing your tour routes. Hacking the security feed to watch your rehearsal footage—”

“He didn’t—?”

“He did,” Anaxa replies, with the steady cadence of someone who’s been living through a slow-burn apocalypse.

There’s a beat. A silence where the air holds tension, and not even Mydei’s iced drink dares make a sound.

“He tracked the delivery route of your custom guitar case through three cities. Cross-referenced every stop with tagged fan photos.”

Mydei blinks. “That’s not even public information.”

“He made it public.”

Anaxa doesn’t even give him time to process before continuing.

“He paid a guy on Etsy to make a custom candle labeled ‘*Mydei’s Scent.*’ It’s just leather and stage fog. I had to issue a cease-and-desist.”

“…Did it sell well?”

“Unfortunately, yes.”

Just as he’s about to spiral further, Mydei’s phone lights up on the table with a soft buzz. A notification. Nothing unusual.

Anaxa grabs it before Mydei can move. Unlocks it without hesitation. Of course he knows the passcode. He set it once when Mydei didn’t care enough to bother.

He stares silently at the screen. Then taps. Scrolls once.

Then pauses.

“You have a photo album,” Anaxa says blankly, “called loser <3.”

There’s a beat.

Mydei, unfazed, reaches for his drink. “Forgot to close out of that.”

Anaxa opens it.

There are hundreds of pictures. Most of them blurry. All of them Phainon. Screaming. Posing. Crying at Mydei’s concert. Holding a signed poster with tears in his eyes. One where he’s mid-jump in a crowd, face red and expression feral.

Fourteen of the exact same shot. Different filters. Slightly different angles.

Anaxa stares into the abyss of boyfriend delusion.

Then he hands the phone back, very calmly.

“That’s why I never reported him,” he says, mostly to himself. “Because you’re just as unwell.”

Mydei doesn’t deny it. He just scrolls to a photo of Phainon theatrically clutching his chest and adds it to the album.

After a long morning of schedules, Anaxa and Aglaea are finishing up their separate meetings with event coordinators, security teams, and sponsor liaisons.

Aglaea, clipboard in hand, has been:

Confirming Phainon's press photoshoot timings with *Vera Nova Magazine.*

Approving an exclusive interview slot where Phainon is legally forbidden to mention Mydei more than once.

Coordinating his surprise stage debut for the opening ceremony.

Anaxa, on the other hand, has just:

Threatened to pull Mydei from a collab stage after he almost refused to do soundcheck.

Reviewed security footage because Mydei "lost" his VIP pass (Phainon was seen wearing it).

Rewritten Mydei's merch booth ad copy because he wrote "hi." as the tagline for everything.

They round opposite corners of the corridor at the same time. Pause. Tension whiplashes the air.

Aglaea smiles—polite, poised, and sharp as glass.

"Fancy seeing you here, Anaxa. What brings you to the civilized side of the industry?"

Anaxa exhales like someone just lit a cigarette in a no-smoking zone. "Don't start. Why are you here?"

They both speak at the same time:

"Tour reroute."

“Special guest slot.”

A pause. They narrow eyes. The implications click into place.

Aglaea inhales slowly. Her voice is still refined, her posture perfect, but every syllable is knifed with quiet dread.

“If your glorified chaos agent thinks he’s coming within ten feet of my stage, I will reintroduce him to restraining orders.”

Anaxa scoffs. “Bold of you to act like your starry-eyed golden retriever isn’t the one who’s going to start barking the second Mydei breathes in his direction.”

Aglaea doesn’t miss a beat. “He only barks when provoked. Maybe your little anarchist shouldn’t post thirst traps with captions like ‘bite?’”

“You people are insane,” Anaxa mutters, pinching the bridge of his nose. “Do you even realize what a PR apocalypse this is gonna be?”

A silence. They stare at each other. The reality sets in.

Cameras. Fans. Sponsorships. And two boyfriends one inconvenience away from public makeout sessions on a jumbotron.
Aglaea sighs. “I hate this.”

Anaxa: “Hate you more.”

Another beat.

They both look away. Then look back. And in unspoken professional resignation:
“…We need a containment plan.”

Enemies by nature. Allies by necessity.

Aglaea opens a shared file labeled: *Damage Control: Lovers Edition.*

Anaxa begins outlining restricted zones with event maps.

They slide into full strategy mode, back-to-back at the coffee bar, sipping herbal tea and cold brew like war generals.

Because at the end of the day… someone has to keep the two most unhinged lovebirds in the industry from igniting the entire expo.

The next day, they moved locations to the VIP lounge that smelled like lavender, aged wood polish, and something far too expensive to be room spray. The furniture gleamed with a quiet smugness—glass tables untouched by fingerprints, leather seats with intimidating angles, and a complimentary espresso bar no one dared to approach without a security clearance.

Aglaea sat like she owned the room. Her coat, fur-lined and snow-white, was draped artfully over the armrest beside her like a statement: Yes, I am better than you, and I moisturize. A sleek tablet glowed in her lap, cycling between security feeds, itinerary spreadsheets, and a draft tweet threatening to dissolve a brand partnership if the color grading on the livestream didn't improve.

The double doors opened without a knock.

Anaxa stepped in like he'd been summoned by a bad omen. Not a hair out of place, coat sharp enough to cut glass, and sipping a cup of green tea he definitely hadn't paid for. He said nothing, just slowly looked her over with the unenthusiastic disapproval of someone reviewing mid-tier wine.

They didn't greet each other.

They didn't need to.

A single glance passed between them—cold, calculating, deeply exhausted—and held for a beat too long. It translated to a shared language only battle-worn managers knew:

If your feral disaster ruins this show, I will personally ruin your life.

Aglaea’s gaze dipped to his tea.

He raised an eyebrow. “The interns were wasting it.”

She adjusted the cuff of her blouse with surgical precision. “I assume your walking disaster of a rockstar is aware this venue has glass walls and a camera crew in every corner?”

Anaxa didn’t even blink. “I assume your overly moisturized himbo hasn’t crawled into the ventilation ducts to find mine.”

“Not yet.”

“Hm.”

They sat.

Aglaea tapped something into her tablet. Anaxa pulled out his phone, opened the new and improved spreadsheet that might’ve changed its title to *Phainon: Legal Nightmares to Date*, then minimized it to focus on the master plan.

What followed was not a discussion—it was an arms deal masked as a logistics meeting. Every exchange precise, pointed, and delivered like poison in a champagne flute.

The plan was this:

Two green rooms on opposite ends of the venue. Soundproofed. Guarded. Phainon-proofed.

Separate entry routes, one of which included a fake tunnel exit in case of fan interference.

Body doubles hired and rehearsed—height, hair, and walk matched. Trained to nod vaguely and wave.

Private dressing rooms, each outfitted with locking mechanisms, noise-canceling systems, and an optional panic button disguised as a light switch.

Split-screen surveillance, monitored by a hand-picked team with strict NDA clauses. Any sighting of “suspicious romantic proximity” would trigger Protocol Bluebell.

Pre-written emergency press statements, color-coded by category: accidental kiss, wardrobe malfunction, unsanctioned proposal, viral edit of them breathing in the same frame.

And—because this was not their first rodeo—a designated intern in a janitor uniform with a tranquilizer pen, just in case.

Aglaea leaned back, inspecting the screen like a commander overlooking a battlefield.

“If all else fails,” she murmured, “I leak a scandal about Castorice—with consent of course— dating that new rookie. He looks ambiguous enough to be believable.”

Anaxa didn’t look up from his tablet. “That’s morally questionable. I respect it.”

She tilted her head. “You’re one stray headline away from a stress-induced jawline fracture. I’d suggest hyaluronic patches.”

“…Send me the link.”

They didn’t smile. But it was close. A rare moment of mutual acknowledgment. Trauma-bonding, PR edition.

And then, in perfect unison, both their phones buzzed.

They didn’t need to read it. They just knew.

Still, Aglaea glanced at hers, lips thinning. “He didn’t.”

Anaxa already had the feed open. “He did.”

On stage, in the middle of his set, Phainon was holding out a ring pop. To Mydei. Under a spotlight. The crowd was screaming. Confetti was falling.

Aglaea shut her tablet slowly. “Tell me he didn’t say the words.”

“Exact quote,” Anaxa muttered, already drafting a suppression notice. “‘Will you marry me? Haha unless?’”

Silence.

Then, Aglaea, deadly calm: “Activate Protocol Bluebell.”

Anaxa sipped his tea. “Already did.”

Somewhere in the quieter wing of the venue—where the lights didn’t strobe and the air still held its dignity—Castorice stood by a locked side door, arms crossed and headphones still draped around her neck. She looked up only when Aglaea’s assistant approached, red-faced and frazzled from navigating Protocol Bluebell’s flaming wreckage.

Without a word, Castorice slipped a USB drive into their hand.

“It’s a compilation of every time he said ‘I’d do it again’ in interviews,” she said softly, gaze steady.

A beat passed.

“…That’s… actually useful,” came Aglaea’s voice, arriving mid-panicked stride behind her assistant. Hair still perfect. Eye twitching.

Castorice nodded once. No flourish, no smugness. Just doing her job—which, apparently, now included containing a romantic menace of mythic proportions.

No one saw it coming. Not the stylists, not the backup dancers, not even Aglaea—who ran operations with an iron mascara wand.

But Castorice? Castorice had been laying the groundwork for months.

She set real-time alerts on every Mydei tag across three platforms. Whenever he posted a song lyric, blinked in an old clip, or wore a new ring, she fed it into curated “fan accounts” anonymously followed by Phainon’s burner TikTok.

She messaged him from one:
@mydeipossiblylovesyou: “omg have u noticed his 2019 lyrics? sounds like ur old poetry???”
Phainon: *[immediately starts writing 7 new verses]*

She rewired his creative mania into music instead of breaking into green rooms disguised as a bass player again.
Her laptop?

A digital minefield.

• Subfolder 1: *Screenshots of Phainon in dumbass poses (eating roses, yelling at pigeons, sleeping in a posture that looked like he fell off a building)*

• Subfolder 2: *Unsent fanfiction titled “Love’s Pyromaniac” even Phainon was embarrassed about*

• Subfolder 3: *Blurry photos from his emo phase back in high school* (captioned “Phainon, age 16, going through something”)

When Anaxa accidentally stumbled on the fact that Castorice had been playing Phainon like a panicked violin this whole time, he stared at her for a solid minute.

“…Do you want to switch managers?”

Aglaea, from across the room, didn’t even look up. “Say that again and I will throw your cosmetics in a microwave.”

The dressing room was quiet—unnaturally so, like the calm after a very elegant storm. The only sound was the faint hum of the overhead lights, soft and sterile, casting a glow over Aglaea's silhouette.

She sat before the mirror, posture still perfect, hair still pinned, makeup still immaculate. But the look in her eyes had dulled. A week of damage control, fake smiles, last-minute rewrites, and crisis management had worn at the corners of her expression. There was a faint twitch at her brow. A subtle, lingering exhaustion behind her lashes.

Aglaea raised a hand to her temple and, one by one, began unpinning her hair. The curls fell slowly, deliberately, like silk surrendering to gravity. She didn't look away from her reflection. Just watched as the version of herself she presented to the world slowly unraveled into something softer. Less cruel. More human.

On the vanity beside her, a previously untouched gift basket sat in pristine silence. She'd scoffed at it earlier—"Who do they think I am, someone with free time and low standards?"—but now her hand drifted over the cellophane wrapping, peeling it back with surgical grace.

A miniature bottle of wine. Lavender-labeled. Cold from the untouched ice pack still hidden beneath the shredded paper.

She twisted off the cap, barely blinking.

Her phone buzzed once.
A message from Anaxa lit up the screen:

Anaxa: Don't think this means I like you. You were just marginally less unbearable this week.

Aglaea stared at the message for a moment. Then, slowly, exhaled through her nose.

A smile tugged at her lips—dry and amused and a little sad. She raised the bottle, tilted it back, and drank.

One long sip.

She didn’t even bother with a glass.

The studio booth was soundproof, but inside, chaos reigned.

Phainon sat hunched over a notepad, headphones askew, a pencil between his teeth and his hair in full mutiny. Dozens of scratched-out lyrics surrounded a centerpiece of pure insanity: one page that simply read “Mydei” seventeen times, in progressively larger handwriting.

He stared at it like it had wronged him.

His phone, perched precariously on the music stand, glowed with an unsent tweet:

> If he breathes in my direction again I’m gonna combust like a microwaved croissant.

He hovered over “post.” Then sighed. Deleted it.

The booth door opened.

Castorice stepped in, perfectly neutral. A hoodie draped over one arm, tea in the other, looking like a ghost who learned work ethic.

“Thought you were gonna work,” she said, one eyebrow raised.

“I was,” he replied, flopping back in his chair. “Emotionally.”

She didn’t dignify it with a response. Instead, she handed him her phone.

On it, a new Mydei Instagram story: a blurry image of stars, captioned *‘soundcheck.’*

“Go write another song or something,” she said, already turning to leave.

Phainon stared after her like she was a prophet.

A few hours later across the hall, the energy was wildly different.

Castorice sat curled into a velvet chair in one of the venue's lesser-used lounges, typing with the kind of calm usually reserved for retired monarchs or cats with nothing to prove.

On her laptop, an email subject line blinked back at her:

"The Importance of Artistic Privacy: An Exclusive Interview."

Below that, a folder labeled Blackmail: Use in Case of PR Collapse had grown—cleanly color-coded, now with subfolders for dates, incident types, and severity tiers. She didn't do it for Phainon. Or for glory. She just felt bad for Aglaea.

And sometimes, when she got bored, she organized things.

Aglaea entered silently, heels clicking to a stop just past the doorway. She stared at the screen for a long second, then said without ceremony:

"Remind me to double your bonus."

Castorice didn't look up. "Already did."

A moment passed between them—quiet and rare. The kind that could almost be mistaken for affection, if you didn't know better.

Finally, without looking away from her screen, Castorice added:

"Also… can we lighten my schedule a little next week?"

Aglaea blinked. "You're doing fine."

"I know. I just don't want to talk to people."

Pause.

"…Fair."

The green room was dimly lit, cool-toned, and too clean for anyone to believe a person had been there longer than ten minutes. A catering tray sat untouched. The TV played muted news coverage of the concert tour—his name scrolled across the bottom in a tasteful gold banner.

Mydei sat on a plush gray couch, one leg propped up, his guitar across his lap like a favorite pillow. His fingers weren't moving, though. They hovered idle over the strings as he scrolled his phone.

A single DM notification lit up.

Phainon✴: [heart emoji]

No words. No punctuation. Just that stupid little heart.

Mydei stared at it for exactly three seconds longer than someone who didn't care.

He didn't reply.

But he smiled, barely—a flicker at the corner of his mouth, like an involuntary muscle twitch he hoped no one saw.

He closed the app. Swiped right instead. Opened the photo album labeled loser <3.

Inside: pure chaos.

1. The same fourteen blurry shots of Phainon from before screaming at his concert
2. One of him eating noodles with terrifying intensity.
3. A few grainy zoom-ins taken from a hotel balcony with zero context
4. One unusually clear photo of Phainon asleep on a studio couch, hoodie pulled over his face.

Mydei paused there.

Just looking.

Then he grabbed a pen from the side table and clicked it once. Tested it on his palm, then shifted slightly and wrote something small on the inside of his forearm, just under a faint line of fading tour marker. A phrase. Maybe a lyric. He covered it with his sleeve the second he was done.

The door cracked open.

Anaxa leaned in, eyes scanning the scene like a disappointed school principal. “You’re being suspiciously well-behaved.”

Mydei didn’t look up. “Maybe I’m tired.”

“Or maybe you’re scheming again.”

He shrugged. “Wouldn’t you like to know.”

Anaxa sighed, muttered something under his breath, and closed the door again.

Mydei waited a beat. Then unlocked his phone.

Mydei: Nice jacket today.

He hit send.

The room is a battlefield of ringing phones, flashing screens, and assistants running on pure adrenaline and iced coffee. Social media dashboards flash crimson. News alerts ping every three seconds. Somewhere, a video is auto-playing of Phainon and Mydei kissing onstage, complete with glitter cannons and an audience screaming like the sky just cracked open.

In the eye of the storm, Aglaea stands perfectly still.

Immaculate nails wrapped around a coffee cup she does not remember acquiring. A pristine blouse, a flawless coat, and a pair of earrings that cost more than most people’s rent. Her hair hasn’t moved since this morning.

Her soul, however, is disintegrating.

The room hushes as she finally speaks, voice glassy and eerily calm.

“Okay,” she says. “Okay. They kissed onstage. And said—what did they say?”

A trembling intern checks the transcript. “Um. ‘Love wins’… ma’am.”

Aglaea’s eye twitches once. Just once.

“That’s fine,” she murmurs, sipping the mystery coffee like it’s wine at a funeral. “That’s… fine. I can work with this.”

The laugh comes slowly. A soft exhale, really. Then a second one. Then a snort. Then, suddenly, she is laughing—a melodic, slightly unhinged cackle that echoes across the room and makes two interns take a step back. One assistant makes the sign of the cross.

Aglaea walks calmly to the whiteboard mounted on the wall. Wipes off the existing plan with the elegance of a swan committing arson. Then picks up a marker and, in beautifully looping handwriting, writes:

NEW PR ANGLE: Star-Crossed Lunatics Power Couple Era.

She circles it twice. Underlines it once.

“We’ll sell it,” she says, now pacing. “We’ll rebrand the chaos. Dramatic. Tragic. Destined. Forbidden romance—but hot. They’ll eat it up.”

She turns, hair swinging like a curtain call.

“The fans love love. The gays will carry us.”

The room remains respectfully silent. Someone in the back claps. Another person sobs softly into a laptop.

The wind howls. His coat billows like a fallen angel in a fragrance ad. The sea churns below, dramatic and entirely fitting.

Anaxa stands alone at the edge, staring into the abyss with the expression of a man who has tried everything: scheduling apps, publicist training, threat assessment seminars, lavender-scented candles.

None of it worked.

In one hand, his phone glows with push notifications:

> “PHAIDEI IS REAL?! BREAKING: Onstage Kiss Confirms Everything.
> “Power Couple or Public Menace? Fans Can’t Decide—But They’re Obsessed.”
> “Anaxa Unfollowed Mydei on Instagram. War or Strategic Marketing?”

He scrolls.

> “BREAKING: New Poll Ranks Top 10 Most Delulu Celebrity Fans, #1 Is Actually One of the Celebrities Themselves.”

He swipes to a final image: a blurry photo of Phainon holding Mydei’s hand mid-kiss, both smiling like idiots. A glitter cannon explodes behind them.

His finger pauses. His soul doesn’t.

He looks out at the horizon, then takes one step forward. Another.

The sea waits. Cold. Indifferent. Soothing.

The camera pans behind him as he steps off the edge and walks calmly into the ocean. No resistance. No hesitation. Just peaceful surrender.

Floating behind him in the wind—a crumpled note, written on the back of an expense report.

To Whom It May Concern:

I did what I could.
The eyeliner was waterproof.
The contracts were ironclad.
The Instagram captions were tragic yet tasteful.

But one cannot stop fate—or two idiots in love with no self-preservation instincts.

If Mydei asks where I went, tell him I left to buy almond milk.
And never came back.

—Anaxagoras

The city outside was still vibrating with aftershocks—trending tags, flashing headlines, shaky concert footage already edited into ten different fan-made montages. But inside the hotel suite, the noise thinned.

Mydei sat cross-legged on the couch, his jacket tossed somewhere by the door, hair still damp from the post-show chaos. He had glitter on his cheek, like he hadn’t noticed, or maybe had and decided to leave it there.

Phainon leaned against the window, half-eaten convenience store sandwich in hand, the wrapper crinkling with every shift of his fingers. He looked tired in a way that wasn’t physical—like adrenaline had finally left his body, and all that was left was this strange stillness.

“You think we ruined everything?” Mydei asked, gaze trained on nothing in particular.

“I think we made Aglaea start laughing in three different pitches,” Phainon answered. “So. Possibly.”

Mydei didn’t smile, not at first. Just nodded like he’d expected that. He leaned back against the cushions, eyes half-lidded, like sleep was circling but never quite landing. “She’ll figure something out. She always does.”

“Anaxa walked into the ocean,” Phainon offered. “He left a note.”

“That’s dramatic.”

“So are we.”

A beat passed. Mydei reached into his pocket and pulled out his phone. Showed the screen without a word—one of the fan edits, hearts and soft filters, their kiss looped on a beat drop.

Phainon raised an eyebrow. “You saving that for personal reasons?”

Mydei didn’t answer right away. Then, coolly, “I like the lighting.”

“Right.”

Silence again, but not heavy.

Phainon moved to sit beside him, close enough that their knees touched. He nudged Mydei’s arm, voice quieter now. “I meant it, you know. Onstage.”

Mydei didn’t look at him, but his fingers twitched slightly where they rested. “I know.”

“I wasn’t planning on saying it. I was gonna keep being normal about this.”

“You’ve never been normal a day in your life.”

Phainon grinned, leaning his head on Mydei’s shoulder with zero shame. “You love it.”

“I tolerate it,” Mydei corrected, but there was no weight to the words. He let Phainon stay there, let his fingers brush against his. “You’re lucky I’m tired.”

“You’re lucky I’m obsessed with you.”

They stayed like that for a moment—quiet, unbothered, the chaos left somewhere behind them in the neon-lit city. Then Phainon spoke again,

muffled against Mydei’s shoulder.

“Do you think we’re ruining our careers?”

Mydei tilted his head slightly. “Maybe.”

“You gonna break up with me so the fans calm down?”

“Not a chance.”

Phainon smiled, full and bright, eyes closed like he was finally at peace.

Outside, the world spun itself into frenzy.

Inside, they didn’t care.

Not tonight.

End Notes

I think I hit my daily quota for Phainon down bad, so for my Chef au I'm probably gonna make it angst or just switch the POV to Mydei??? Idk, maybe just light hearted romance? Jealous Phainon? Mydei? BUT I WANNA ADD TO MY PHAIDEI/MYPHAI GONE WRONG COLLECTION!!! BUT ALSO CHAPTER 7 OF PAPER CUTS N PYRESS??? AND THE URGE TO FINALLY HOP MY ASS BACK ONTO WRITING CHAPTER 3 OF AFTER HOURS AHH I gotta think this one through😭

(I am NOT ready for 3.2 tho, I still haven't recovered emotionally from 3.1 omg I need someone to hold my hands through it)

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